

August 12, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Sammie Zemlak (MRN MUSC3070109), Claim MUSC-20250918-7D92-3

Patient	Sammie Zemlak (DOB 1959-01-28)
MRN	MUSC3070109
Member ID / Group	BCB250343600 / GRP-96407
Claim number	MUSC-20250918-7D92-3
Date of service	2025-09-18
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$485.78
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2026-01-29

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center submits this formal reconsideration request on behalf of Sammie Zemlak (MRN: MUSC3070109, Member ID: BCB250343600, Group: GRP-96407) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20250918-7D92-3 for services rendered on September 18, 2025. BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina denied the claim under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") with RARC N115, citing a Local Coverage Determination, and further stated that "documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$250.45.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Zemlak is a 67-year-old male with a complex, active chronic disease burden that directly elevates the medical necessity of any acute respiratory evaluation. His documented active conditions include chronic congestive heart failure (I25.10), anemia (D64.9), prediabetes, and longstanding hypertension managed with hydrochlorothiazide. He carries active prescriptions for furosemide injection, Lasix 40 mg, and metoprolol succinate extended-release, reflecting ongoing cardiovascular management. His history also includes multiple prior episodes of acute upper respiratory illness, including viral sinusitis, acute bacterial sinusitis, and acute bronchitis across several prior encounters. On September 18, 2025, Mr. Zemlak presented to MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center as an established outpatient patient with an acute upper respiratory infection (J06.9), with anemia (D64.9) recorded as a secondary diagnosis. The visit was rendered by Amara J. Boone, NP (NPI 1203948576) at Place of Service 22.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of CPT 99214 for this encounter is not supported by the clinical facts of record. CPT 99214 describes an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring moderate-complexity medical decision-making. Mr. Zemlak's presentation with acute upper respiratory infection against a background of active congestive heart failure, anemia, hypertension, and prediabetes — each requiring ongoing pharmacologic management — objectively elevates the complexity of any acute respiratory evaluation beyond a straightforward encounter. Distinguishing a new acute upper respiratory infection from a cardiac or pulmonary exacerbation in a patient on furosemide and metoprolol requires the kind of clinical assessment and decision-making that appropriately supports a moderate-complexity level of service. The secondary diagnosis of anemia (D64.9), itself an active condition managed with ferrous sulfate, further contributes to the complexity of the encounter. The payer's assertion that documentation does not establish medical necessity does not account for the cumulative clinical burden this patient carries, which is fully reflected in the medical record. MUSC Health requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina conduct a clinical review of the complete encounter documentation, including the patient's active problem list and medication regimen, in evaluating this appeal.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-20250918-7D92-3 and reprocess the claim for payment at the contractually allowed amount of \$250.45. Should the reviewer require additional clinical documentation, MUSC Health will provide it promptly upon request. We ask that this reconsideration be completed within the timeframe required under applicable prompt-pay and appeal-rights obligations. This appeal is submitted in advance of the January 29, 2026 reconsideration deadline through the My Insurance Manager portal, with the remittance advice and supporting medical records attached.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC
Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management

MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record